



Girish Venkatasubban, CEO of Imaxx Sports, Shiv Prakash Singh, founder of Shiv Naresh Sports and Lakshita Mehrotra, senior team lead at Foundation for Economic Development at the Sportstar Focus Bihar Conclave. R.V. MOORTHY

India at a major cost disability in sports goods manufacturing

Team Sportstar

Lakshita Mehrotra, senior team lead, Foundation for Economic Development, said that India needs to fix demand and supply-side problems to emerge as a leading manufacturer of sports goods. "On the supply side, we are at a major cost disability right now. If a manufacturer in India produces a football for Rs. 100, the same football can be made in Pakistan or China for less than Rs. 85 or 87. We need to bridge this gap. This is due to raw material disadvantage, high cost of machinery, the lack of available land, and high logistical costs.

"On the demand side, there are several challenges. Because we are

currently an MSME-led industry, there is not enough visibility. There are no anchor brands, like *Nike* or *Adidas*. They are not coming here, because of which the tech transfer is not happening, because of which certification bodies have not yet set up in India, and because of which India has not been able to create its own brands, except for cricket," she said at the *Sportstar Focus Bihar Conclave*.

Girish Venkatasubban, CEO, Imaxx Sports, also proposed a way to help India compete with sports goods manufacturers from across the world. "Imitate and innovate. Once we have imitated the global standards, then we can innovate. We can

club a lot of products and bring all the solutions in a single product. The main problem is that by the time we imitate, the global standards are going higher. We will have to stop imitating and look 10 steps ahead.

Shiv Prakash Singh, founder of Shiv Naresh Sports urged the government for higher demand of domestically manufactured goods.

"Whenever the government issues a purchase order, it all goes to

foreign brands. Only when

domestic demand increases will more players enter the industry. If other players don't enter the market, then manufacturing hubs in only Meerut and Jalandhar won't cut it. When domestic markets get bigger, exports will

